

PHASE 7A APPROVED DEVELOPMENT BRIEF

What we are going to build, who it serves, and how the approved HRMS platform will work



Web image: Wikimedia Commons team meeting photo, used as a collaboration visual.

Conclusion

Phase 7A is the first full development phase of the HRMS platform. It builds the secure SaaS foundation first, adds Branch/Office Hierarchy and Shift Foundation, then delivers Core HR, Leave, Attendance, Payroll with India compliance, and Standard Reports. The approved design is built for configuration, audit, tenant safety, branch-scoped operations, shift-aware time data, and future modules without changing core code.

Approved package	Status
75 implementation documents	Approved
5 hardening standard/backlog documents	Approved
Total Phase 7A development documentation	80/80 Approved

1. What Phase 7A Is

Phase 7A is the foundation and first working product phase for the HRMS platform. It is not only a set of HR screens. It is the base that allows the product to become a configurable, multi-tenant, enterprise-grade HRMS.

- It creates a secure tenant-aware platform where each customer is isolated.
- It allows one tenant to operate child branches/offices with separate branch admins and scoped employee access.
- It gives HR teams configurable rules, workflows, policies, reports, and approvals.
- It delivers everyday HR operations: employee records, self-service, branch assignment, leave, shift-aware attendance, payroll, payslips, and reports.
- It creates the architecture needed to add later modules without rebuilding the core.

Simple meaning

Phase 7A is the platform proof: first build the strong base, then build the core HR workflows on top of that base.

2. Who This Phase Is For

User group	What they will use
Employees	View profile, request leave, see attendance, access payslips, use self-service changes.
Managers	Approve leave and attendance changes, view team data, track pending work, and see shift-aware attendance context.
HR Admins	Manage employees, policies, leave setup, attendance rules, workflows, and reports.
Payroll Teams	Run payroll, validate exceptions, approve results, publish payslips, manage India compliance.
Tenant Admins	Manage configuration, branch/office hierarchy, feature flags, module settings, security, and approvals.
Auditors and Security Teams	Review audit trails, time-machine history, access evidence, and export controls.

3. What We Are Going To Develop

The approved scope is split into platform foundations and business modules.

Area	Approved delivery
Tenant Catalog + RLS	Customer isolation, tenant context, and row-level security.
Branch / Office Hierarchy	Child branches/offices, branch admin scope, employee branch assignment, and branch-aware reporting.
Identity + RBAC/ABAC	Login, roles, permissions, policy-based access, sessions, and emergency access controls.
Effective Dating	History-aware records so the system knows what was true on any date.
Audit / Time Machine	Every important action is traceable, searchable, and reconstructable.
Event Bus + Outbox	Reliable module-to-module communication without tight coupling.
Rule Engine	No hardcoded HR or payroll policies; rules are configurable, versioned, and testable.
Workflow Studio	Approvals, delegation, SLA, escalation, versioned workflow definitions.
Configuration-as-Data	Feature flags, forms, policies, rules, reports, navigation, and settings as governed data.
Core HR + ESS	Employee master, assignments, org data, and self-service requests.
Leave	Leave types, accruals, balances, approvals, calendars, and payroll impact.
Attendance + First Connector	Punch capture, regularization, one connector framework, payroll attendance feed.
Shift Foundation	Basic shift templates, employee shift assignment, overrides, shift resolver, and shift-aware attendance/payroll.
Payroll + India Compliance	Salary structures, payroll runs, payslips, PF/ESI/PT/LWF/TDS/Form 16 foundation.
Standard Reports	Operational and statutory reports with security, filters, exports, and audit.

4. How The Product Will Work For Users

Workflow	Simple operating flow
Employee self-service	Employee requests a profile change or leave; workflow routes approval; result updates record and audit.
Leave	Employee applies; rules check balance/calendar; manager approves; balance ledger updates; payroll/report events fire.
Branch operations	Tenant admin creates offices; branch admins work only within approved branch scope; reports and exports respect that boundary.
Attendance	Punches arrive from web/manual/connector; effective shift is resolved; daily summary calculated; corrections approved; payroll receives payable-day data.
Payroll	Payroll team runs dry run from Core HR, Leave, and shift-aware Attendance; resolves exceptions; approval locks results; payslips published; reports generated.
Configuration	Admin drafts policy/workflow/rule; system validates impact; approval; publish; rollback available.
Audit and reports	Authorized users search history, view as-of data, export evidence, and track who changed what.

Operating principle	Every important change is approved where required, audited, evented, tenant-safe, and explainable.
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5. What Is Not Being Built In Phase 7A

- Recruitment, performance, LMS, engagement, expenses, assets, service desk, and advanced onboarding are later phases.
- Multi-country payroll packs are later; Phase 7A is India-first payroll and compliance foundation.
- Advanced roster planning, shift swaps, and workforce demand planning are later phases. Phase 7A includes the basic Shift Foundation needed for attendance and payroll.
- Advanced BI, marketplace, and full AI assistant capabilities are not part of the Phase 7A development scope.
- Customer-specific changes must not be hardcoded into core logic.

6. Architecture In Simple Language



Web image: Wikimedia Commons server infrastructure photo, used as a platform architecture visual.

- Multi-tenant SaaS: many customers can use the platform, but their data stays isolated.
- Branch-scoped SaaS: a tenant can have child branches/offices; tenant admins see all, while branch admins see only approved branches.
- Security first: every API checks tenant, user identity, role, permissions, and policy.
- Rules-as-data: HR and payroll policies live in configurable rule sets, not in code.
- Workflow-as-data: approval flows are versioned definitions, not hardcoded paths.
- Event-driven backbone: modules communicate through reliable events such as BranchScopeAssigned, LeaveApproved, ShiftDefinitionPublished, or PayrollRunPublished.
- Effective dating and time machine: changes are historical, explainable, and usable for payroll and reporting.
- Open for extension: new modules connect through manifests, APIs, events, providers, and configuration.

7. Development Order

The approved order is dependency-led. Business modules come only after the platform foundations they need.

Sprint	Theme	Expected result
S1	Tenant + Identity + Branch Scope	Every request is tenant-safe, branch-aware, and permission-aware.
S2	Effective Dating + Audit + Events	History, audit, and events work across the platform.
S3	Rule + Workflow + Configuration	Rules, approvals, and configuration are data-driven.
S4	Core HR + ESS	Employee master, branch assignment, and self-service are usable.
S5	Leave	Leave policies, applications, approvals, and balances work.
S6	Attendance + Shift Foundation + Connector	Shift-aware attendance capture and first connector feed payroll.
S7	Payroll Engine	Payroll run, components, calculations, and payslips work.
S8	India Compliance	PF, ESI, PT, LWF, TDS, Form 16 foundation, FBP, revisions.
S9	Workflow Hardening	Delegation, SLA, escalation, and migration are hardened.
S10	Reports + Hardening	Reports, exports, performance, security, and release readiness.

8. Security, Audit, and Quality Controls

- Every table is tenant-scoped and every query must be tenant-filtered.
- Every module supports RBAC, ABAC, audit logging, and OpenAPI documentation.
- Critical operations need idempotency so retries do not duplicate payroll, leave, attendance, or workflow actions.
- PII and payroll-sensitive data require classification, masking, encryption, retention, and export controls.
- Tests include tenant-abuse cases, cross-tenant export attempts, role changes, impersonation audit, and security checks.
- Target coverage is at least 85%, with higher focus on payroll calculations, rules, ledger, and security paths.

9. What Has Been Approved

Document set	Count	Status
Business Requirements	15	Approved
Technical Designs	15	Approved
Database Designs	15	Approved
UI Designs	15	Approved
Test Plans	15	Approved
Phase 7A Hardening Standards / Backlog	5	Approved
Total Phase 7A development documentation	80	Approved

10. How To Operate Phase 7A After Build

- Admins configure tenants, branches/offices, roles, features, rules, workflows, calendars, shifts, payroll policies, and reports.
- Employees and managers use the portal for self-service, leave, attendance, approvals, and payslips.
- Payroll teams run dry runs first, resolve exceptions, seek approval, lock payroll, and publish payslips.
- Support and auditors use audit search, time-machine views, event trace, report history, and export evidence.
- Every change should be made through configuration, workflow, rule versions, or provider adapters, not direct code changes.

11. Implementation Guardrails

Guardrail	Meaning
No code before approved docs	This gate is now complete for Phase 7A documentation.
No hardcoded business rules	Leave, attendance, payroll, workflow routing, and eligibility use Rule Engine/configuration.
No customer-specific core changes	Customer behavior must be delivered through configuration, extensions, feature flags, providers, and plugins.
OpenAPI mandatory	Every API must be versioned and documented before implementation is complete.
Event-driven where possible	Approved events connect modules without direct database coupling.
Tenant isolation always	Every module must enforce tenant context and prevent cross-tenant access.

12. Source and Image Credits

- Approved internal documents: Phase 7A business requirements, technical designs, database designs, UI designs, test plans, and hardening standards under the project docs folder.
- Roadmap source: ROADMAP-001 phased delivery, approved roadmap.
- Web image: WLM international team meeting Vienna 2023-05-27 12, Wikimedia Commons, used as a collaboration visual.
- Web image: Wikimedia Servers-0051 19, Wikimedia Commons, used as an infrastructure visual.
- Web reference themes used in approved docs: Microsoft SQL Server temporal/RLS documentation, OpenAPI Specification, CloudEvents, RabbitMQ reliability, OpenFeature, OWASP API Security, WCAG 2.2, EPFO, ESIC, Income Tax India, and market references including Zoho People, Keka, greytHR, BambooHR, and Darwinbox.